TOPIC 01 · FUNDAMENTALS OF GOOGLE SHEET
LAB 3 THEME · DATA PREP

Lab 3 — Clean and Prepare the Candidate Data with Gemini Actions

Maps to	LO1: prepare raw HR data with Gemini actions and Sheets data-cleanup tools - remove duplicates, find and replace, set number formats, insert and delete columns, freeze, sort, filter and format as a table
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Google Sheets · Gemini actions (find and replace, number format, insert/delete column, freeze, sort, filter, table style) · Data cleanup
Mock data	data/OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Prep.xlsx
Course	Gemini for Google Sheet (C817) · v2.0
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-3

Goal

Turn the raw Q3 export into a clean, analysis-ready table of 240 applications, keeping a count before and after every change.

What You Will Do

You fix everything you found in Lab 2. Gemini explains how to remove duplicates, then performs actions for you: find and replace the Source variants, convert text salaries to numbers with a currency format, add a clean name column, delete the notes column, freeze the headers, apply a table style, and sort and filter the data. A multi-step prompt finishes the clean-up in one go. You check the row count after every change.

What You Will Build

OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Prep as a clean table: 240 rows, seven Source values, numeric S$ salaries, a Name_Clean column, frozen headers, a Stage dropdown and Hired rows highlighted

Prerequisites

- Lab 2's list of issues (or its Test It values) to hand.
- This lab folder downloaded, including data/OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Prep.xlsx.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional Orchid Bay data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real candidates' or employees' personal data into Gemini, the AI function or a Gem unless your organisation has approved it.

Steps

Step 1. Download OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Prep.xlsx from this lab's data folder. In Google Drive choose New > File upload, open the uploaded file, then choose File > Save as Google Sheets - Gemini works best on a native Google Sheets file. Close the .xlsx tab and work only in the new Google Sheets copy. At the top right, click Ask Gemini (the spark icon) to open the Gemini side panel. Read the About_This_Data tab before you prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Required state:
File : OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Prep (Google Sheets copy)
Tabs : About_This_Data | Applications | Jobs | Prompt_Log
Start : 243 rows, 17 columns (including Internal_Notes)
```

Step 2. Ask Gemini how to remove duplicates, then follow its steps: select the whole Applications data range (click A1, then Ctrl + A), choose Data > Data cleanup > Remove duplicates, tick 'Data has header row' and all columns. Sheets should report 3 duplicate rows removed, 240 rows remain.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ASK GEMINI:
How can I remove the duplicate rows on the Applications tab and keep one copy of each?
```

Step 3. Fix the Source spellings with a Gemini action and click Apply on the preview card. Then remove the trailing space from 'JobStreet ' and the double spaces in names: select columns B and G and choose Data > Data cleanup > Trim whitespace. Open the filter on Source (Data > Create a filter) - you should see exactly 7 values.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
In the Source column, find 'Linked In' and 'linkedin' and replace them with 'LinkedIn'.
```

Step 4. Fix the data types and the impossible value one change at a time, clicking Apply after each preview. Afterwards =COUNT(K2:K241) must return 240 - every salary is a number. The recruiter confirmed that CAN-26607 has 3 years of experience.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
1) In the Expected_Salary column, find 'S$' and ',' and replace them with nothing.
2) Set the number format of the Expected_Salary column to currency S$ with no decimal places.
3) For Candidate_ID CAN-26607, change Years_Experience from -3 to 3.
```

Step 5. Tidy the structure. The new Name_Clean column fixes names typed in capitals or with extra spaces; check that it is filled all the way to the last row. Then remove the notes column - screening does not need free-text notes about candidates - and freeze the headers.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
1) Insert a new column named Name_Clean to the right of Full_Name and fill it with
=PROPER(TRIM(B2)) down to the last row.
2) Delete the Internal_Notes column.
3) Freeze the top row and the first column.
```

Step 6. Apply a table style, then sort and filter. Gemini's sort and filter apply to the active table. Note the filtered count - it should be 2 rows - then clear the filter so all 240 rows show again. If the table style is not applied, select the data and choose Format > Convert to table.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
1) Apply a table style to the data on the Applications tab to make it easier to read.
2) Sort the table by Applied_Date in descending order.
3) Filter for Software Engineer candidates whose Source is Referral.
4) Clear the filter so all rows are visible.
```

Step 7. Finish with one multi-step prompt - Gemini combines several actions in a single request. Check each part: dates show as yyyy-mm-dd, Stage has a dropdown, and 11 Hired rows are light green.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
Finish cleaning this table: format Applied_Date as yyyy-mm-dd, make the Stage column a
dropdown with Applied, Screened, Shortlisted, Interviewed, Offered, Hired, Rejected and
Withdrawn, and highlight in light green the rows where Stage is Hired.
```

Step 8. Prompt_Log already lists every prompt in this lab with its step. Ask Gemini to recap the conversation, copy each line into What Gemini did, add How I verified in your own words, and choose Keep, Revise or Undo in the Decision dropdown. Google Sheets saves automatically. Tip: the side-panel history is lost when you reload the page, so insert or copy anything you want to keep.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
LOG:
List the prompts I sent you in this conversation. For each one, give a one-line summary of
what you did, so I can copy it into the Prompt_Log tab.
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Gemini side panel in Google Sheets (or adapt them). Name the tab and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

Copy-ready prompts online: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-3

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Fill	Fill the empty Email cells with the text 'missing - ask candidate'.
2	Insert	Insert a new column called Source_Group after Source and leave it empty.
3	Number format	Format Screening_Score as a whole number and Interview_Score with one decimal place.
4	Delete rows	Delete the rows where Stage is Withdrawn.
5	Help	How do I split the Key_Skills column into separate columns?

Test It

Check	Expected result
Rows	240 rows after removing 3 duplicates.
Source	Exactly 7 values in the filter; LinkedIn 49, JobStreet 50.
Salaries	=COUNT over the Expected_Salary column returns 240; values show as S$ with no decimals.
Structure	Name_Clean filled to the last row; Internal_Notes gone; headers frozen; CAN-26607 shows 3 years.
Sort, filter, dropdown	Newest date (2026-09-26) at the top; the filter showed 2 rows; Stage dropdown added; 11 Hired rows light green.

Checkpoint

This clean table is the starting point for Lab 4, which supplies the same 240 rows (plus a Budget_Max column) in its own workbook.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Salaries still align left after the find and replace.	They are still text. Select the column and choose Format > Number > Number, or ask Gemini: 'Convert the Expected_Salary values to numbers.'
Gemini replaced 'LinkedIn' everywhere in the sheet.	Click Undo and name the column: 'In the Source column only ...'.
Name_Clean stops part-way down.	Ask Gemini to 'fill the formula down to row 241', or double-click the fill handle on C2.
No action card appears for sort, filter or table style.	Do it from the menu: Data > Sort range, Data > Create a filter, Format > Convert to table.
Sort mixed up the rows.	Undo, then make sure the whole table is selected (or converted to a table) before sorting.
Remove duplicates removed 0 rows.	You selected only part of the data. Select from A1 to the last row and column, then run it again.

Challenge

Ask Gemini to add a Source_Group column that labels LinkedIn, JobStreet, MyCareersFuture and Indeed as 'Job board' and the rest as 'Direct'. Check the two groups add up to 240.

Reflection

Why should you fix data in a helper column, or keep the original, rather than overwrite it?